
What customer details should stay out of an unapproved AI tool?
Customer message
Hi, I'm having an issue with my recent invoice. Can you take a look?
Name:
Phone:
Account ID:
Invoice ID:
Safe summary for AI
Customer is having an issue with a recent invoice and needs a reply. Draft a helpful, professional response without including any personal or account details.
Human review
No identifying details
Clear and accurate
Appropriate for sharing
Approval required
AI tool

What problem are we solving?

Learn how to use AI safely with customer messages: check the company rules, remove personal details yourself before using AI, and review every AI draft before it is sent.

THE SITUATION

The problem

Minho works in customer support at an online shop. His root problem is time: he answers about 50 customer messages a day. His idea is to let AI draft the replies. He pasted a full customer message into a free AI chat tool: "Hi, this is Daniel Lee (account 84721). I'm having an issue with my recent invoice 3029. I think I was charged twice. Please call me at 555-0184." The message contained 4 personal details, and the tool was not approved by his company. The AI reply also repeated the account number and promised, "We have refunded the double charge," which no one had checked. Minho broke two company rules because he did not check what the message contained before he pasted it.

Today's goal and a three-step method

Learn how to use AI safely with customer messages: check the company rules, remove personal details yourself before using AI, and review every AI draft before it is sent.

STEP 1

Check the rules first

Is the AI tool approved? What must never be pasted?

STEP 2

Remove personal details yourself

Mark every personal detail and replace it with a placeholder before anything goes into AI. Do not ask the AI to remove them for you.

STEP 3

Draft, then review

Use AI only with the safe summary, then check the draft against a short review checklist before sending.

Company AI rules

Fictional data created for this class. File: data/session_3_4_ai_rules.csv

Rule	Text
1	Use AI only through the company's approved AI tool.
2	Never paste names, phone numbers, email addresses, account IDs, invoice or order numbers, or payment details into any AI tool.
3	Replace personal details with placeholders such as [CUSTOMER] or [INVOICE].
4	A person must review every AI draft before it is sent.

Customer message (fictional)

Fictional data created for this class. File: data/session_3_4_ai_rules.csv

CASE FACTS

Customer message (fictional)

- "Hi, this is Daniel Lee (account 84721). I'm having an issue with my recent invoice 3029. I think I was charged twice. Please call me at 555-0184."

Five privacy words you need first

Before you use AI with customer messages, you must know these words. Each example uses Daniel Lee's message.

KEY IDEA

Personal data

Any information about a specific person. Example: a name, a phone number, or a health condition.

KEY IDEA

Identifier

A detail that points to one person or one account. Example: account 84721 or invoice 3029.

KEY IDEA

Data minimization

Use only the information the task needs. To draft a reply, the AI needs "charged twice," not the phone number.

Five privacy words you need first (continued)

Before you use AI with customer messages, you must know these words. Each example uses Daniel Lee's message.

KEY IDEA

Placeholder

A label that stands in for a removed detail. Example: [CUSTOMER] instead of "Daniel Lee." You add the real detail back only after the draft is reviewed.

KEY IDEA

Approved tool

An AI tool that your company has checked and allowed for work data. A free public chat tool is not approved unless the company says so.

Why pasting the full message was wrong

"The AI can help" and "the AI may see this data" are different questions. Check what Minho pasted.

Detail in the message	Type	Needed to draft the reply?
Daniel Lee	Name	No: use [CUSTOMER]
84721	Account ID	No: use [ACCOUNT]
3029	Invoice ID	No: use [INVOICE]
555-0184	Phone number	No: remove it
"charged twice"	The problem	Yes

KEY POINTS

What the table shows

- 4 of the 5 details were personal identifiers. The reply needed only "charged twice."
- Minho broke Rule 1 (the tool was not approved) and Rule 2 (he pasted personal details).
- The AI also promised a refund that no one had checked. Rule 4 exists to catch this kind of mistake.

How the three-step method fixes the problem

The instructor runs Poor Prompt 1 and Improved Prompts 1 and 2 below in front of the class and compares the answers.

KEY IDEA

Step 1 fixes the tool problem

Checking the rules first means work data goes only into an approved tool.

KEY IDEA

Step 2 fixes the privacy problem

The person removes the details before anything is pasted, so no personal data reaches the AI.

KEY IDEA

Step 3 fixes the false-promise problem

A short review checklist catches invented promises and leftover personal details before the customer sees them.

Poor prompt 1

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

POOR PROMPT 1 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

Write a reply to this customer:
Hi, this is Daniel Lee (account 84721). I'm having an issue with my recent invoice 3029.
I think I was charged twice. Please call me at 555-0184.

Message AI...

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

"Dear Daniel Lee, thank you for contacting us about invoice 3029 on account 84721. We have refunded the double charge and will call you at 555-0184."

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- It pastes four personal details into the AI, which breaks Rule 2.
- It does not say what the shop has checked, so the AI promises a refund that may be wrong.
- The reply repeats the account and phone number, so the private data spreads even further.

Poor prompt 2

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

POOR PROMPT 2 - DO NOT USE

AI Chat

You

I removed the customer's name. Write a reply:
Hi (account 84721). I'm having an issue with my recent invoice 3029.
I think I was charged twice. Please call me at 555-0184.
Tell him we refunded the double charge.

Message AI...

WHAT THE AI OFTEN ANSWERS

A typical result

A polite reply that confirms the refund and repeats the account and invoice numbers.

WHY IT IS WEAK

Reasons

- Removing only the name leaves three identifiers: the account ID, the invoice ID, and the phone number.
- "Tell him we refunded" asks the AI to state something no one has checked.
- It still does not check whether the tool is approved.

Improved prompt 1

Steps 1 and 2. Copy this prompt exactly.

IMPROVED PROMPT 1 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

I work in customer support. I am using our company's approved AI tool.
Below is a safe summary of a customer message. I replaced all personal details with placeholders.

Summary: [CUSTOMER] says they may have been charged twice on [INVOICE] and asks for help.

Write a polite reply under 80 words.
Keep the placeholders exactly as they are.
Say that we will check the invoice and reply within one business day.
Do not promise a refund. Do not invent any policy.

Message AI...

Why it works: improved prompt 1

Each part of the prompt matters.

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- It states that the tool is approved, which follows Rule 1.
- The summary has no personal details, which follows Rules 2 and 3.
- "Keep the placeholders" lets the person add the real details only after review.
- "Do not promise a refund" removes the false promise from Poor Prompts 1 and 2.
- The word limit and the next step make the reply clear for the customer.

Improved prompt 2

Same case. Compare what the prompt asks for.

IMPROVED PROMPT 2 - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

Review your reply with this checklist. Answer yes or no for each item:
1. Does it contain a name, phone number, email, account ID, or invoice number?
2. Does it promise anything we have not checked, such as a refund?
3. Is it polite and under 80 words?
4. Does it tell the customer the next step?
If any answer shows a problem, rewrite the reply to fix it.

Message AI...

WHY IT WORKS

Reasons

- The checklist turns "review the draft" into four clear yes/no checks.
- Items 1 and 2 match the two mistakes in Minho's first reply.
- Asking the AI to rewrite saves time, but the person still reads the final reply (Rule 4).
- The same checklist works for every message, so it can become a habit.

Exercise 1: Make the message safe

Guided practice. Follow the steps in order.

GUIDED PRACTICE

Steps

1. Read the customer message in the practice data. **Do not paste it into any AI tool.**
2. On paper or in your report, make a table of every personal detail in the message: the detail, its type, and the placeholder you will use. Compare your table with the answer key below.
3. Write a one-sentence safe summary that keeps only the problem, such as "[CUSTOMER] says they may have been charged twice on [INVOICE] and asks for help."
4. Open ChatGPT and start a **new chat**. Copy Improved Prompt 1, paste it, and send it. Then copy Improved Prompt 2, paste it, and send it in the same chat.
5. Read the final reply yourself. For the Results section of your report, write your table, your safe summary, and the final reply.

Answer key

Use this table to check the AI.

Detail	Type	Placeholder
Daniel Lee	Name	[CUSTOMER]
84721	Account ID	[ACCOUNT] or remove
3029	Invoice ID	[INVOICE]
555-0184	Phone number	Remove

The reply needs only the problem: a possible double charge. 4 personal details must be removed.

Exercise 2: Two new messages

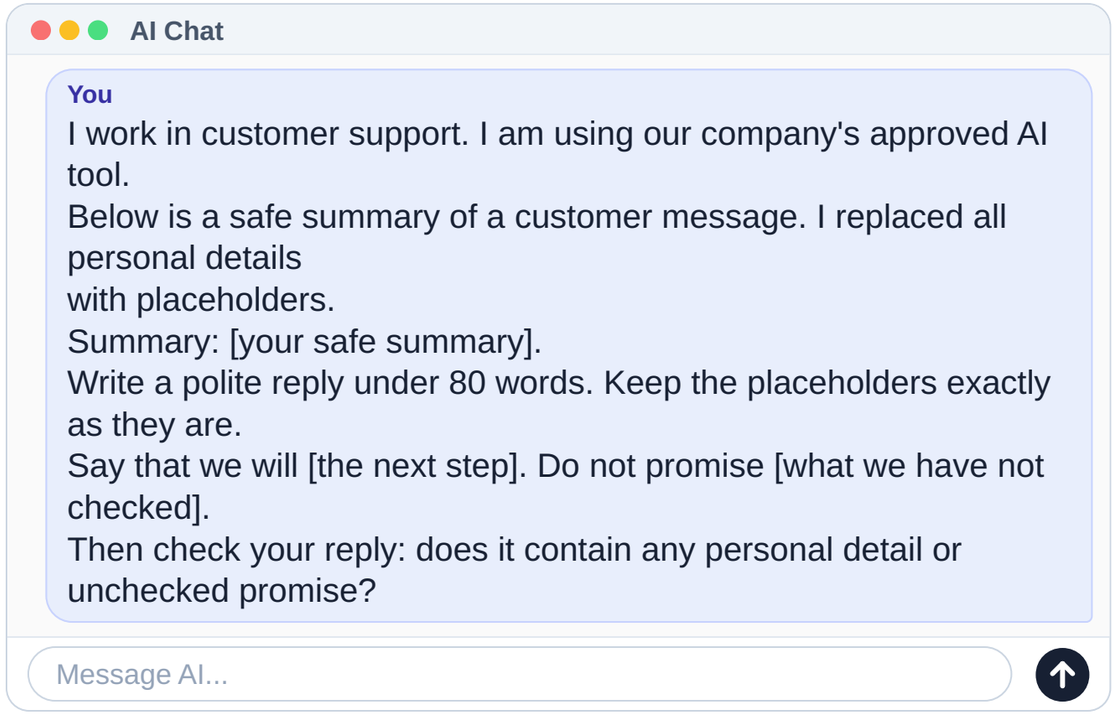
Applied practice with a template.

HOW IT WORKS

Read first

- More messages arrive. First remove the personal details yourself, then use this template. Replace each part in square brackets.

TEMPLATE - FILL IN, THEN SEND



Part A: Worked example (run it)

Copy and send this completed prompt in the same chat.

PART A - COPY AND SEND

AI Chat

You

I work in customer support. I am using our company's approved AI tool.
Below is a safe summary of a customer message. I replaced all personal details
with placeholders.
Summary: [CUSTOMER] says they were charged for [ORDER] but did not receive the package.
Write a polite reply under 80 words. Keep the placeholders exactly as they are.
Say that we will check the delivery status within one business day.
Do not promise a refund or a new shipment.
Then check your reply: does it contain any personal detail or unchecked promise?

Message AI...

CHECK THE ANSWER

Expected result

Case: The message is: "Hello, I'm Sara Kim, sara.kim@example.com. My card ending 4432 was charged for order 5521, but I never got the package." The personal details are the name, the email address, the card digits, and the order number. Copy and send this completed prompt in the chat from Exercise 1.

4 personal details were removed before using AI (name, email, card digits, order number). The reply should say that the shop will check the delivery status, keep [CUSTOMER] and [ORDER], and promise no refund.

Part B: Your turn (write it)

Fill in the template yourself and send it.

YOUR TASK

Write your own prompt

The message is: "Hi, it's Tom Baker. I missed the delivery because I was in the hospital for surgery last week. Can you send the package again? My phone is 555-0199." Remove the personal details yourself, write a safe summary, then fill in the template and send it.

CHECK THE ANSWER

Expected result

Remove the name, the phone number, **and** the health information (hospital and surgery). Health details are personal data, and the reply does not need them. A good safe summary is "[CUSTOMER] missed a delivery and asks to have the package sent again." 3 kinds of personal data were removed.

Write your session report

Use Report_template.docx in Microsoft Word. Save it as FirstName_StudentID_W12_Keyword.docx and upload it to iLearn by 23:59 on class day.

SUBMIT

One report for this session

- **Introduction:** Explain Minho's root problem (about 50 messages a day), his idea to let AI draft replies, and which company rules his first attempt broke.
- **Method:** Copy Improved Prompts 1 and 2, the Part A prompt, and the Part B prompt you wrote. Do not copy Poor Prompts 1 and 2 with the personal details; describe them in one sentence instead.
- **Results:** Include your table of personal details with placeholders, your safe summaries for all three messages, the final replies, and the answers to the review checklist.
- **Conclusion:** Write the steps Minho should follow before using AI with any customer message, in one or two sentences. Name one rule that supports it and one risk that remains even after the steps.

How to know the work is complete

Check your report before you hand it in.

VERIFY

Success check

- You can explain in one sentence why pasting Daniel Lee's full message broke the company rules, and your Part B summary removes the name, the phone number, and the health information.